

OFFICIAL SPEECH TRANSCRIPT — SPEECH 2
HUMANITARIAN AID & REFUGEE SUPPORT

AGENDA ITEM

Humanitarian Aid & Refugee Support

Honorable Chair, Distinguished Delegates,

The delegation of Croatia wants to address the urgent crisis of displacement affecting millions of Ukrainian families. Today, over 4 million Ukrainians are living as refugees in EU countries, carrying both the physical and mental wounds of war.

For Croatia, this is not just a statistic on a paper. In the 1990s, our own citizens had to flee their homes with nothing but a single bag. We know what it means to lose everything overnight. This is why Croatia has opened its doors, providing Ukrainian refugees with immediate housing, healthcare, and education.

To address the first and fourth questions of our study guide, we propose two main actions:

First, we must establish standardized "Humanitarian Welcome Centers" at NATO borders, offering immediate psychological first aid and safe temporary shelter.

Second, we must focus on long-term social integration. Giving refugees a place to stay is not enough; we must help them learn local languages, enter the job market, and enroll their children in schools.

Let us remember that refugees are not a burden to be managed, but human lives to be protected.

Thank you, and I yield my time back to the Chair.

Delegation of Croatia
North Atlantic Council Session